



Residents of Sarajevo, Bosnia, duck sniper shots at a peace march during the Bosnian War as radical Serbs open fire on them.



The division of Yugoslavia

After 72 years, Yugoslavia disappeared from the map of Europe after war and political upheaval led to the formation of six independent countries.

(see 1990). He refused to comply, and on January 17, the US and coalition forces launched "Operation Desert Storm," also known as the **First Gulf War** (1990–91). Kuwait was liberated after five weeks.

The First Gulf War left Saddam Hussein vulnerable in Iraq. There were **antigovernment uprisings by Shi'ite Muslims** in the south of the country and by **Kurds** in the north. During March and April, thousands of people were killed as Saddam crushed the revolts.

In India, **Rajiv Gandhi** (b. 1944), the former prime minister, was **assassinated** on May 21. He was

killed by a bomb in the town of Sriperumbudur while campaigning with his party for the forthcoming elections. A female suicide bomber from Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam (LTTE), a guerilla group in Sri Lanka also known as the "**Tamil Tigers**," was later found to have been responsible.

On August 8, **John McCarthy**, a British journalist held hostage by an Islamic extremist group in Lebanon, was **released after five years in captivity** (see 1986). Later in the year, fellow British hostage Terry Waite, and Americans Terry Anderson and Tom Sutherland were also freed.

THE IDEA OF A UNITED EUROPE CAME CLOSER TO REALIZATION

when leaders of 12 European countries signed the **treaty on European Union** and the **Maastricht Final Act** on February 7. It heralded common citizenship, and common economic and defence policies.

The break up of Yugoslavia continued as **Bosnia and Herzegovina declared independence** on March 3. Serbs living in Bosnia, however, resisted the move. **War broke out** and the



UN PEACEKEEPING

United Nations Peacekeeping emerged out of World War II as a way to place military personnel between warring countries or communities to stop fighting. UN forces were first used as an observer to monitor the armistice between Israel and the Arab states in 1948. Its role has grown substantially since then: supervising elections, checking human rights, clearing land mines, and intervening in failed states. By 1992, UN Peacekeeping forces had made 26 interventions worldwide.

6,000 THE NUMBER OF BOSNIANS AND CROATS HELD IN OMARSKA DEATH CAMP

Yugoslav army under Slobodan Milosevic attacked the Muslim population of Bosnia. The capital, Sarajevo, came under siege from Bosnian Serbs. Supplies became short and people struggled for survival (see 1996).

In August, footage of **Serbian prison camps**, showing starving men behind barbed-wire fences, sparked outrage around the world. The camps, mostly in Bosnia, were part of Serbia's "**ethnic cleansing policy**" that called for the removal of other ethnic groups from Serb-dominated communities.

On December 20, **Slobodan Milosevic was reelected** as Serbian president. Prime minister Milan Panic called for fresh elections, citing fraud. After nine days, Panic lost a parliamentary vote of no confidence.

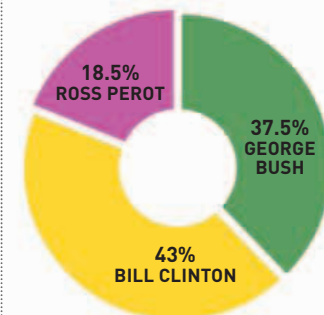
Algerian president **Mohammed Boudiaf** was **assassinated** on June 29 at a rally in Annaba. Boudiaf had been instrumental in the Algerian uprising against France (see 1958). He had recently returned from exile to help the government combat the Islamic

Salvation Front, a fundamentalist party, whom many believed was responsible for the assassination.

US Marines waded onto the shores of **Somalia** on December 9. Somalia was **stricken by famine**, but extortion and looting prevented foreign aid from getting through. The US-led operation aimed to hold Mogadishu's airport to enable supplies to be airlifted to starving locals.

The **Los Angeles police department** was accused of **racism and excessive force** after a video of four policemen savagely beating a black man, **Rodney King**, was broadcast in 1991. The officers were acquitted in a trial, triggering **race riots** on April 29, which led to 55 casualties.

On November 4, Democrat **Bill Clinton** (b. 1946) **beat George Bush** (b. 1924) in the US presidential elections. Clinton promised to lift the US out of economic stagnation.



Clinton's victory
Bill Clinton became the 42nd president of the US by beating opponents Ross Perot and George Bush.

August 29 Soviet Parliament suspends all communist activities
August 26 Dubrovnik shelled by Serbian troops
September 8 Macedonia declares independence
October 5 Death of former British Parliamentarian and media magnate **Robert Maxwell** (b. 1923)
October 23 Vukovar surrenders to Federal Army of Yugoslavia
October 30 Spain hosts historic Middle East peace talks
November 19 Hostage Terry Waite released in Beirut
December 2 Ukraine votes for independence
December 25 Mikhail Gorbachev resigns as Soviet president

February 7 Maastricht Treaty signed
March 3 Bosnia declares independence from Yugoslavia
March 22–29 Elections in Albania end communist rule
April 29 Race riots begin in Los Angeles
May 2 Death of Hollywood actress **Martene Dietrich** (b. 1911)
May 30 UN imposes sanctions on Serbia
June 2 Danish voters reject Maastricht Treaty
June 29 Summer Olympics open in Barcelona, Spain
June 29 President **Mohammed Boudiaf** of Algeria assassinated (b. 1919)
August 15 Footage of Serbian death camps shown around world
October 3 Large-scale protests held in Germany against racial violence
November 4 Bill Clinton elected as US president